

● HARD

● ALGEBRA

● ANSWER KEY

Algebra

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Q1**D****D.** 71

Choice D is correct. Multiplying the second equation in the given system by 2 yields

$\frac{10}{2}x + 12y = 46$. Adding this equation to the first equation in the system yields $\frac{7}{2}x + 6y + \frac{10}{2}x + 12y = 25 + 46$, which is equivalent to $\frac{7}{2}x + \frac{10}{2}x + 6y + 12y = 25 + 46$, or $\frac{17}{2}x + 18y = 71$. Therefore, the value of $\frac{17}{2}x + 18y$ is 71.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the value of x , not the value of $\frac{17}{2}x + 18y$.

Choice B is incorrect. This is the value of y , not the value of $\frac{17}{2}x + 18y$.

Choice C is incorrect. This the value of $\frac{7}{2}x + 6y + \frac{5}{2}x + 6y$, or $6x + 12y$, not the value of $\frac{17}{2}x + 18y$.

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Q2**.5**

Accept also: 1/2

The correct answer is $\frac{1}{2}$. For an equation in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, m represents the slope of the line in the xy -plane defined by this equation. It's given that line p is defined by $4y + 8x = 6$. Subtracting $8x$ from both sides of this equation yields $4y = -8x + 6$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 4 yields $y = -\frac{8}{4}x + \frac{6}{4}$, or $y = -2x + \frac{3}{2}$. Thus, the slope of line p is -2 . If line r is perpendicular to line p , then the slope of line r is the negative reciprocal of the slope of line p . The negative reciprocal of -2 is $-\frac{1}{-2} = \frac{1}{2}$. Note that $1/2$ and $.5$ are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Q3**-12**

The correct answer is -12. It's given that the functions f and g are defined as $fx = \frac{1}{4}x - 9$ and $gx = \frac{3}{4}x + 21$. If the function h is defined as $hx = fx + gx$, then substituting $\frac{1}{4}x - 9$ for fx and $\frac{3}{4}x + 21$ for gx in this function yields $hx = \frac{1}{4}x - 9 + \frac{3}{4}x + 21$. This can be rewritten as $hx = \frac{4}{4}x + 12$, or $hx = x + 12$. The x -intercept of a graph in the xy -plane is the point on the graph where $y = 0$. The equation representing the graph of $y = hx$ is $y = x + 12$. Substituting 0 for y in this equation yields $0 = x + 12$. Subtracting 12 from both sides of this equation yields $-12 = x$, or $x = -12$. Therefore, the x -coordinate of the x -intercept of the graph of $y = hx$ in the xy -plane is -12.

Q4

D

D. Zero

Choice D is correct. A system of two linear equations in two variables, x and y , has zero solutions if the lines representing the equations in the xy -plane are distinct and parallel. Two lines are distinct and parallel if they have the same slope but different y -intercepts. Each equation in the given system can be written in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the line representing the equation in the xy -plane and b is the y -intercept. Adding $12x$ to both sides of the first equation in the given system of equations, $-12x + 14y = 36$, yields $14y = 12x + 36$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 14 yields $y = \frac{6}{7}x + \frac{18}{7}$. It follows that the first equation in the given system of equations has a slope of $\frac{6}{7}$ and a y -intercept of $\frac{18}{7}$. Adding $6x$ to both sides of the second equation in the given system of equations, $-6x + 7y = -18$, yields $7y = 6x - 18$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 7 yields $y = \frac{6}{7}x - \frac{18}{7}$. It follows that the second equation in the given system of equations has a slope of $\frac{6}{7}$ and a y -intercept of $-\frac{18}{7}$. Since the slopes of these lines are the same and the y -intercepts are different, it follows that the given system of equations has zero solutions.

Alternate approach: To solve the system by elimination, multiplying the second equation in the given system of equations, $-6x + 7y = -18$, by -2 yields $12x - 14y = 36$. Adding this equation to the first equation in the given system of equations, $-12x + 14y = 36$, yields $(-12x + 12x) + (-14y + 14y) = 36 + 36$, or $0 = 72$. Since this equation isn't true, the given system of equations has zero solutions.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q5**C**

C. The total number of cups of vegetable broth in the large jars

Choice C is correct. It's given that the equation $3x + 5y = 32$ represents the situation where Keenan filled x small jars and y large jars with all the vegetable broth he made, which was 32 cups. Therefore, $3x$ represents the total number of cups of vegetable broth in the small jars and $5y$ represents the total number of cups of vegetable broth in the large jars.

Choice A is incorrect. The number of large jars Keenan filled is represented by y , not $5y$.

Choice B is incorrect. The number of small jars Keenan filled is represented by x , not $5y$.

Choice D is incorrect. The total number of cups of vegetable broth in the small jars is represented by $3x$, not $5y$.

Q6**A**

A. 3.78

Choice A is correct. It's given that the function $F(x) = \frac{9}{5}x - 273.15 + 32$ gives the temperature, in degrees Fahrenheit, that corresponds to a temperature of x kelvins. A temperature that increased by 2.10 kelvins means that the value of x increased by 2.10 kelvins. It follows that an increase in x by 2.10 increases $F(x)$ by $\frac{9}{5} \cdot 2.10$, or 3.78. Therefore, if a temperature increased by 2.10 kelvins, the temperature increased by 3.78 degrees Fahrenheit.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q7

D

D. $4x + 10y = 32$
 $-8x - 10y = -64$

Choice D is correct. A line in the xy -plane that passes through the points x_1, y_1 and x_2, y_2 has slope m , where $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$, and can be defined by an equation of the form $y - y_1 = mx - x_1$. One of the lines shown in the graph passes through the points 8, 0 and 3, 4. Substituting 8 for x_1 , 0 for y_1 , 3 for x_2 , and 4 for y_2 in the equation $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$ yields $m = \frac{4 - 0}{3 - 8}$, or $m = -\frac{4}{5}$. Substituting $-\frac{4}{5}$ for m , 8 for x_1 and 0 for y_1 in the equation $y - y_1 = mx - x_1$ yields $y - 0 = -\frac{4}{5}x - 8$, which is equivalent to $y = -\frac{4}{5}x + \frac{32}{5}$. Adding $\frac{4}{5}x$ to both sides of this equation yields $\frac{4}{5}x + y = \frac{32}{5}$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by -10 yields $-8x - 10y = -64$. Therefore, an equation of this line is $-8x - 10y = -64$. Similarly, the other line shown in the graph passes through the points 8, 0 and 3, 2. Substituting 8 for x_1 , 0 for y_1 , 3 for x_2 , and 2 for y_2 in the equation $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$ yields $m = \frac{2 - 0}{3 - 8}$, or $m = -\frac{2}{5}$. Substituting $-\frac{2}{5}$ for m , 8 for x_1 , and 0 for y_1 in the equation $y - y_1 = mx - x_1$ yields $y - 0 = -\frac{2}{5}x - 8$, which is equivalent to $y = -\frac{2}{5}x + \frac{16}{5}$. Adding $\frac{2}{5}x$ to both sides of this equation yields $\frac{2}{5}x + y = \frac{16}{5}$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by 10 yields $4x + 10y = 32$. Therefore, an equation of this line is $4x + 10y = 32$. So, the system of linear equations represented by the lines shown is $4x + 10y = 32$ and $-8x - 10y = -64$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q8**B**

B. $10x + 7y = 1$
 $ax + 2by = 1$

Choice B is correct. Two lines are perpendicular if their slopes are negative reciprocals, meaning that the slope of the first line is equal to -1 divided by the slope of the second line. Each equation in the given pair of equations can be written in slope-intercept form, $y = mx + b$, where m is the slope of the graph of the equation in the xy -plane and b is the y -intercept. For the first equation, $5x + 7y = 1$, subtracting $5x$ from both sides gives $7y = -5x + 1$, and dividing both sides of this equation by 7 gives $y = -\frac{5}{7}x + \frac{1}{7}$. Therefore, the slope of the graph of this equation is $-\frac{5}{7}$. For the second equation, $ax + by = 1$, subtracting ax from both sides gives $by = -ax + 1$, and dividing both sides of this equation by b gives $y = -\frac{a}{b}x + \frac{1}{b}$. Therefore, the slope of the graph of this equation is $-\frac{a}{b}$. Since the graph of the given pair of equations is a pair of perpendicular lines, the slope of the graph of the second equation, $-\frac{a}{b}$, must be the negative reciprocal of the slope of the graph of the first equation, $-\frac{5}{7}$. The negative reciprocal of $-\frac{5}{7}$ is $\frac{7}{5}$, or $\frac{7}{5}$. Therefore, $-\frac{a}{b} = \frac{7}{5}$, or $\frac{a}{b} = -\frac{7}{5}$. Similarly, rewriting the equations in choice B in slope-intercept form yields $y = -\frac{10}{7}x + \frac{1}{7}$ and $y = -\frac{a}{2b}x + \frac{1}{2b}$. It follows that the slope of the graph of the first equation in choice B is $-\frac{10}{7}$ and the slope of the graph of the second equation in choice B is $-\frac{a}{2b}$. Since $\frac{a}{b} = -\frac{7}{5}$, $-\frac{a}{2b}$ is equal to $-\frac{1}{2} \cdot -\frac{7}{5}$, or $\frac{7}{10}$. Since $\frac{7}{10}$ is the negative reciprocal of $-\frac{10}{7}$, the pair of equations in choice B represents a pair of perpendicular lines.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q9**B****B. -5**

Choice B is correct. Subtracting the second equation, $4x - 8y = 9$, from the first equation, $7x - 5y = 4$, results in $(7x - 5y) - (4x - 8y) = 4 - 9$, or $7x - 5y - 4x + 8y = 5$. Combining like terms on the left-hand side of this equation yields $3x + 3y = -5$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from miscalculating $4 - 9$ as -13 . Choice C is incorrect and may result from miscalculating $4 - 9$ as 5. Choice D is incorrect and may result from adding 9 to 4 instead of subtracting 9 from 4.

Q10**30**

The correct answer is 30. The slope of a line can be found by using the slope formula, $\frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$.

It's given that the slope of the line is 2; therefore, $\frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1} = 2$. According to the table, the points $(3, 7)$ and $(k, 11)$ lie on the line. Substituting the coordinates of these points into the equation gives $\frac{11 - 7}{k - 3} = 2$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by $k - 3$ gives

$11 - 7 = 2(k - 3)$, or $11 - 7 = 2k - 6$. Solving for k gives $k = 5$. According to the table, the points $(3, 7)$ and $(12, n)$ also lie on the line. Substituting the coordinates of these points into $\frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1} = 2$ gives $\frac{n - 7}{12 - 3} = 2$. Solving for n gives $n = 25$. Therefore, $k + n = 5 + 25$, or 30.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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